Each morning and after meals, monks chew on wood sticks called *dantkashtha*, extracted from certain stems or roots—such as from *Ficus indicus* or banyan tree—to clean their mouths and tongues. Though the wood stick is usually a bit astringent or pungent in taste, it apparently 'hardens the teeth, scents the mouth, helps to digest food, or relieves heart-burning'.

Clothes too, including undergarments, must follow certain rules for both monks and nuns: the material and length of the cloth and the waistband, their cut, stitch and colour, how much skin they can reveal and where, how the robe is pleated, wrapped and handled, say, while seated ('your knees are to be covered but your shanks may be bare'; with nuns, 'even in a urinal one must not have one's shoulders bare'), and so on. Yijing himself seems more than a little obsessed with such rules of hygiene, eating, bathing, dressing, worshipping, greeting, sleeping and many other aspects of personal conduct—even 'rules concerning evacuation', i.e., emptying the bowels—so it's not always easy to separate actual practices at Nalanda from Yijing's own obsessions and disciplinarian prescriptions for his audience. In a bid to ensure that his Chinese audience takes him seriously, he often adds that these rules were 'laid down by the Buddha himself'! I amuse myself trying to imagine the Buddha going on about 'rules concerning evacuation'.

At the end of summer comes a day of confession and 'atoning for faults'—faults that either one realizes in oneself, or are perhaps pointed out by others. The idea of confession is to declare, 'with perfect sincerity', one's own offence and past faults in order to 'alter the past conduct and repair the future'. There were other ways to show errant monks their place too. 'In case a monk bragged and used other's belongings, he was teasingly called *Kulapati*', or a householder, an insult for a monk. Egregious violations of the code could even lead to expulsion from the monastery, though no examples are mentioned in the Chinese accounts.

When a monk or priest dies, his corpse is carried on a bier to the cremation ground. While the corpse burns, 'friends assemble and sit on one side', 'the Sutra of Impermanence is recited by a skilled man', and each man silently meditates on his own impermanence. After the ceremony, they bathe together in a pond, return to their rooms and 'cleanse the floor with powdered cow-dung'. If the dead person was especially revered or beloved, they build a small stupa, containing, as stupas tend to do, some of his